



ECHUNGA FAMILY CHURCH

# Baptism of a Child

Thank you for bringing your child to be baptised. It is one of the best things we do.

When we baptise a child, we are saying something about God before we say anything about the child: that God's love arrives first, before any of us have done a thing to deserve it. Your child will not remember the day. That is rather the point.

Baptism is also a promise the whole congregation makes — to help your child grow up knowing they are loved by God and belong here. You will hear us make it out loud.

## About your child

FULL NAME, AS YOU WOULD LIKE IT READ OUT

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WHAT THEY ARE CALLED

DATE OF BIRTH

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PLACE OF BIRTH

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## About you

PARENTS' OR GUARDIANS' FULL NAMES

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ADDRESS

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POSTCODE

PHONE

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EMAIL

YOUR CONNECTION WITH ECHUNGA

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SPONSORS OR COMPANIONS — SOMETIMES CALLED GODPARENTS — IF YOU ARE HAVING THEM

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## The one thing we ask of you

### A PARENT DECLARES THEIR OWN FAITH

During the service, at least one parent or guardian is asked to declare their own Christian faith. It is three short questions: do you repent of your sins, do you turn to Christ, do you commit yourself to God. You answer in a sentence each.

- ☐ Yes, we are happy to do that.
- ☐ We would like to talk about it first.

For those unsure about making this declaration, we can also offer a service of Thanksgiving for the Birth of a Child.

## If your child is older

Some children are old enough to want to answer for themselves, and there is no minimum age in our church. Where that is the case, Church Council decides — on the minister's advice — whether your child comes as an adult candidate answering the questions themselves, or as a child candidate with you carrying the responsibility. Both are proper. If your child is answering for themselves, use the form **Taking the Step** instead.

- ☐ Our child would like to answer for themselves.
- ☐ We would carry the responsibility.

## What happens next

- 1 A conversation — at church or at your kitchen table, whichever suits.
- 2 Church Council is asked to approve, which is ordinary and straightforward.
- 3 We settle on a Sunday that works for your family and anyone travelling.
- 4 Baptism happens in the middle of the normal service, with everybody there.

Anything you would like us to know, or anything you would like to ask?

SIGNED

DATE

**Rev Nicholas Tuohy**

**SENIOR PASTOR**

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Return your completed form to the church office, or bring it with you — and if anything here raises a question, please get in touch first. We keep a record of every baptism, as our church requires of us. What you write here is used for that and for ordinary pastoral contact, and is not shared outside the church. Echunga Family Church is a member congregation of the Uniting Church of South Australia.